

PHASE 1: CONCEPTION PHASE

CRM CHALLENGE FOR SAYAMI MORTGAGE SOLUTIONS

Introduction

Customer orientation is a critical success factor for financial institutions such as mortgage providers. In a competitive market, Sayami Mortgage Solutions aims to strengthen its Customer Relationship Management (CRM) by identifying weaknesses in customer-facing processes. Understanding these process gaps is essential for improving customer acquisition, retention, and loyalty. Research shows that the CRM-supported process improvements help organizations enhance service quality and customer satisfaction (Chen & Popovich, 2003).

Business Process Overview

The selected business process is the Customer Mortgage Application Lifestyle. This process involves several customer touchpoints and directly impacts customer experience and company profitability.

Key Process Steps:

1. Customer visits the website and submits a mortgage inquiry form
2. A preliminary loan offer is generated based on the provided details
3. The customer uploads the required documents
4. The application is reviewed and processed by the underwriting team
5. The loan is either approved or rejected
6. The customer is onboarded, and loan servicing begins
7. Post-loan, the company engages customers for satisfaction feedback and future refinancing offers

CRM studies emphasize that mapping customer journeys helps organizations identify service gaps and optimize processes (Payne & Frow, 2005).

Identified Weaknesses

High Abandonment During Inquiry Stage (Customer Acquisition)

Many customers drop out before completing the application. Complex forms, unclear instructions, or slow responses can cause this. Research confirms that poor digital experience is a major cause of customer abandonment (Gefen, 2002).

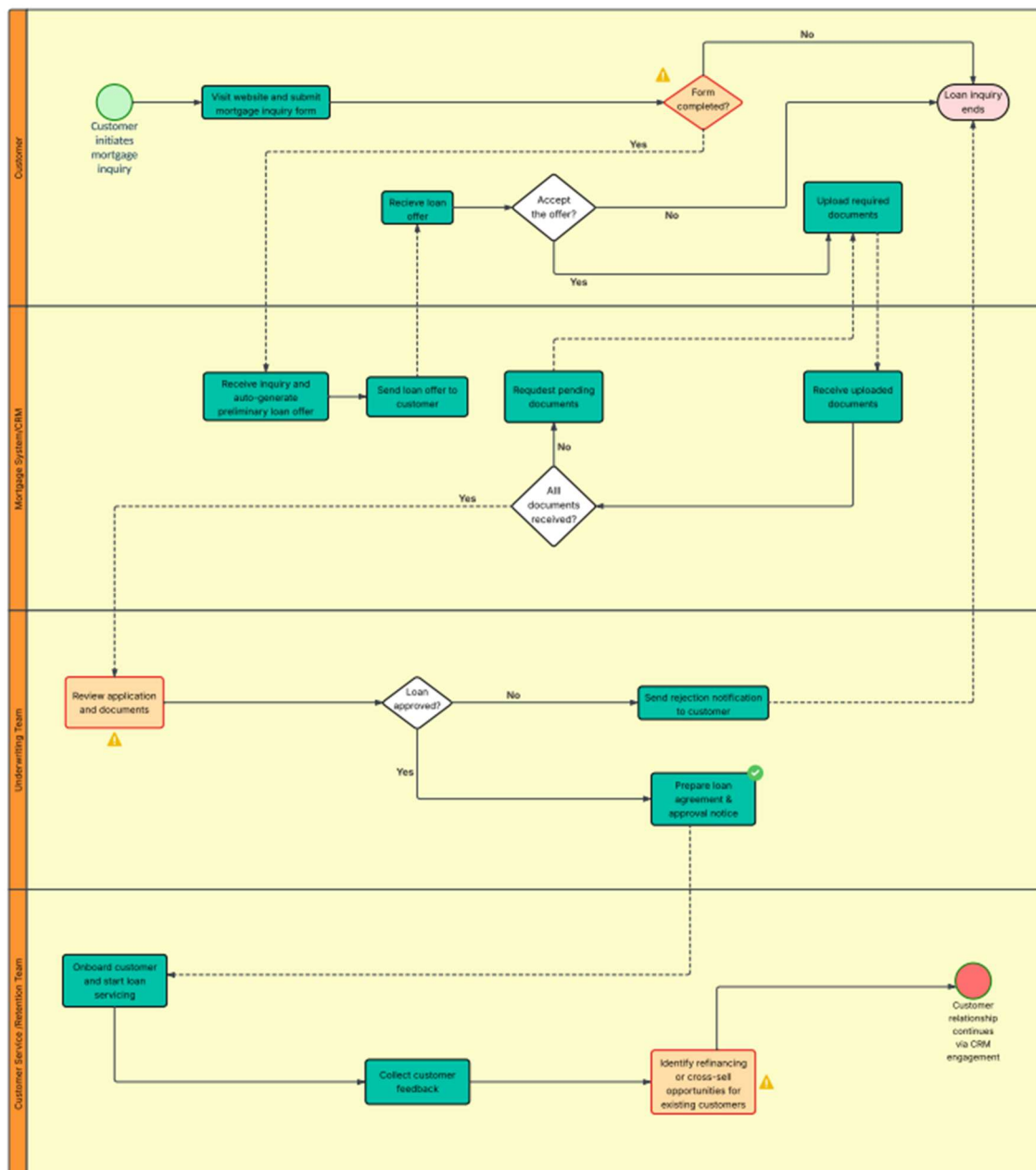
Delays in Underwriting and Application Review (Customer Retention)

Slow processing times reduce customer satisfaction and harm conversion rate. Studies show that waiting time and lack of transparency significantly influence customer trust and retention (Dagger & Sweeney, 2006).

Limited Post-Loan Engagement (Customer Loyalty)

A lack of communication after loan approval leads to missed opportunities for cross-selling and refinancing. CRM research highlights that continuous engagement increases loyalty and customer lifetime value (Reinartz & Kumar, 2002).

Business Process Diagram for Sayami Mortgage Solutions



Key Questions

Sayami Mortgage Solutions aims to improve CRM performance by addressing weaknesses in its Customer Mortgage Application Lifestyle. The analysis highlights three major challenges: high drop-off rates before customers complete the mortgage form (Customer Acquisition), delays or rejections during loan processing (Customer Retention), and limited customer engagement after loan disbursement (Customer Loyalty).

Based on these observations, the following management questions are formulated:

1. What customer characteristics or behaviours are linked to successfully completing a mortgage application form?
2. Which factors contribute most to delays or rejections during the loan processing stage?
3. Which customers are most likely to engage with refinancing or additional mortgage-related products?

These questions provide a clear direction for deeper analysis in later project phases. Clearly defining business problems at this stage ensures that the company can focus on improving the most critical parts of the process. CRM research emphasizes that identifying the right questions early enables more effective customer-focused improvements (Payne & Frow, 2005).

References

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